

# Inside bones

Bones are made up of different types of bone tissue. In the outer parts of the bone the tissue is dense, but in the inner parts it is lighter. This combination makes bones strong enough to support weight but not so heavy that the body cannot move.

## Structure of a bone

The view inside a bone shows its structure. The outer layer of hard, heavy, compact bone is made of tiny, bony tubes called osteons. It encloses lighter spongy bone. A central cavity contains yellow bone marrow.

**Blood vessels**  
supply bone cells  
with nutrients  
and oxygen

**Epiphysis** is the  
rounded end of  
the bone

**Spongy bone**  
is not squishy,  
as its name  
may suggest.  
It consists of  
a network of  
bony struts that  
make it strong  
but light.

